1. What is the purpose of the touch command?

The touch command is mainly used to quickly create new, empty files without opening an editor. I also use it if I need to update the timestamp on an existing file without modifying its contents.

2. Difference between cp and mv?

cp stands for copy, which duplicates a file or folder so the original stays in place and a new copy is created elsewhere. mv stands for move, which transfers the file to a new location or renames it, removing it from the original spot.

3. How do you rename a file in Linux?

the mv command to rename files. You just type mv old_filename new_filename.

4. Difference between > and >>?

Both redirect output into a file, but > overwrites whatever is currently in the file with new content. >> appends the new text to the end of the existing file without erasing anything.

5. What is the purpose of the cat command?

cat (short for concatenate) is used to display the entire content of a file directly in the terminal, combine multiple files into one, or create a quick file.

6. Difference between cat and less?

cat prints the whole file's content all at once onto the terminal screen. less opens the file in a scrollable, full-screen view so you can navigate through it page-by-page or line-by-line.

7. Why is less preferred for large files?

Because less doesn't load the entire file into memory at once—it loads it page by page as you scroll. If you use cat on a huge file, it can flood your terminal and freeze your session.

8. What does the head command do?

head displays the beginning part of a file. By default, it shows the first 10 lines.

9. What does the tail command do?

tail displays the end part of a file. By default, it shows the last 10 lines.

10. What is the purpose of tail -f?

tail -f keeps the file open and continuously displays new lines as they get added in real time, which is super useful for monitoring live log files.

11. What information does wc provide?

wc stands for word count. By default, running wc on a file gives you three numbers: line count, word count, and byte/character count.

12. What does wc -l count?

The -l option tells wc to output only the line count of a file.

13. What is the purpose of the file command?

The file command checks and tells you the actual type of a file

14. Difference between Nano and Vim?

Nano is a simple text editor with helpful keyboard shortcuts displayed right on the screen. Vim is a modal text editor (it has Normal, Insert, and Visual modes) that is faster and more powerful.

15. How do you save and exit Vim?

First, press Esc to make sure you are in Normal mode. Then type :wq and press Enter

16. How do you exit Vim without saving?

Press Esc to get to Normal mode, then type :q! and press Enter. The ! forces Vim to quit without saving any changes.

17. Why is Vim important for DevOps engineers?

Vim is installed by default on almost every Linux distribution and server environment. As a DevOps engineer, when you SSH into remote servers or containers, you often won't have a graphical interface, so knowing Vim ensures you can edit configuration files anywhere.

18. What is the purpose of cp -r?

The -r option stands for "recursive." You use cp -r when you want to copy a folder along with all its subfolders and files inside it.

19. Which command is used to monitor logs in real time?

The tail -f command is used to monitor log files as they update in real time.

20. Which command is used to identify a file type?

The file command is used to identify a file's type.